Scale Exercises - Section IV, Level 36

A Major Pentatonic Expressive Articulation: legato, slides, bends, releases, and vibrato

FIXED KEY: A | FIVE POSITIONS | FRETS 4-17

Keep the A-major-pentatonic pitch map fixed and change the **attack, connection, pitch motion, and sustain**. Every unpicked arrival must remain rhythmically exact, and every bend must reach a named scale tone.

1. Pick once, sound twice

Use one attack per string pair. Hammer the ascending partner and pull off the descending partner at equal volume.

2. Bend to a named pitch

Every core bend rises exactly two frets in pitch. Compare the bend directly with the printed target fret.

3. Add vibrato after accuracy

First stabilize the fretted or bent pitch. Then use small, timed pulses that return to the pitch center.

Worked overview - Position 1 top-string cadence

A major pentatonic: A B C# E F#. The line uses hammer-on, pull-off, whole-step bend, release, and root vibrato.

```
e|--5h7p5-------------------------|
B|----------7p5--------------------|
G|--------------4b(6)r4------------|
D|----------------------7~~~~------|
   A-B-A   F#-E   B-C#-B     A
   1-2-1    6-5    2-3-2     1
```

MODULE A	Five position legato cells	120 tones / 60 attacks
MODULE B	One-pick seam chains	120 tones / 24 attacks

SOUND

Equal volume at every picked and unpicked arrival.

PITCH

Match every bend to the fretted target before adding vibrato.

MUTING

Silence adjacent strings during bends and position changes.

Session protocol

1. Say the notation and target degree.
2. Learn one Position 1 legato cell.
3. Repeat with D-start and U-start.
4. Add one shared-anchor seam chain.
5. Calibrate one bend against its target.
6. Add pre-bend release and vibrato.
7. Finish with one cadence phrase.

Core-workout count and safety boundary

165 pick attacks, plus 240 counted legato/slide tones, 15 bend or pre-bend cells, 8 A-root vibrato holds, and 5 cadence phrases. All core bends are whole steps. Do not substitute the three-semitone gaps 3->5 or 6->1; those require one-and-a-half-step bends and are outside this level.

IMPORTANT - Expression is not permission to lose pulse, pitch, or muting. Stop if bending causes pain.

Level 36 - Articulation Notation and Target Atlas

Every symbol names a timed event; every bend target is an A-major-pentatonic note.

Symbol	Meaning	Execution rule
h	Hammer-on	Pick the lower note; fret the upper note on the next subdivision.
p	Pull-off	Pre-fret the lower note; use a tiny lateral pluck, not a passive lift.
/	Ascending slide	The destination is a sounding tone and must arrive exactly in time.
\	Descending slide	Maintain pressure only through the move; release after arrival.
b(T)	Bend to target T	Bend the source until its pitch matches target fret T.
r	Release	Return from the bent pitch to the source pitch under control.
pb(T)	Pre-bend to T	Reach target pitch silently before the pick attack, then release.
~	Vibrato	Pulse around a stable pitch; return to center between pulses.

String	Source	Target	Degree path	Note path
G	4	6	2->3	B->C#
G	9	11	5->6	E->F#
G	14	16	1->2	A->B
B	5	7	5->6	E->F#
B	10	12	1->2	A->B
B	12	14	2->3	B->C#
High e	5	7	1->2	A->B
High e	7	9	2->3	B->C#
High e	12	14	5->6	E->F#

A-root vibrato map

String	Frets	Role
Low E	5, 17	low tonic and octave tonic
A	12	middle-register tonic
D	7	root inside Position 1/2 seam
G	14	upper-middle tonic
B	10	upper tonic inside Positions 2/3
High e	5, 17	outer-string tonic and octave tonic

Hold each A for four beats. First use four narrow pulses, then six, then free vibrato while preserving the pitch center.

Bend setup

1. Bend toward the center of the fretboard.
2. Use ring finger support from fingers 1 and 2 when practical.
3. Rotate the wrist; do not lift with one isolated finger.
4. Mute strings above with the fretting index and below with the picking hand.
5. Hold the target before adding vibrato.
6. Stop if the hand, wrist, or string feels unsafe.

CORE BENDS: WHOLE STEP ONLY - SOURCE TO A TARGET TWO FRETS HIGHER

Level 36 - Module A: Position 1 Legato Cell

Root frame. frets 4-7. Roots: E5, D7, e5. One pick attack per two-note group.

String	Frets	Notes	Degrees	Fingers
Low E	5-7	A-B	1-2	2-4
A	4-7	C#-E	3-5	1-4
D	4-7	F#-A	6-1	1-4
G	4-6	B-C#	2-3	1-3
B	5-7	E-F#	5-6	2-4
High e	5-7	A-B	1-2	2-4

Attack cycle

12 groups / 24 tones / 12 attacks.
D-start: D U D U D U | D U D U D U
U-start: U D U D U D | U D U D U D

Do not re-pick the hammer-on or pull-off arrival. Do not restart at the high-string turn.

Position 1 - 24-tone hammer-on / pull-off cell

Ascending groups use h from low E to high e. Descending groups use p from high e to low E. The high endpoint is re-attacked to begin the descending half.

```
Nte|   AhB   |   C#hE  |   F#hA  |   BhC#  |   EhF#  |   AhB   |   BpA   |   F#pE  |   C#pB  |   ApF#  |   EpC#  |   BpA   |
Deg|   1h2   |   3h5   |   6h1   |   2h3   |   5h6   |   1h2   |   2p1   |   6p5   |   3p2   |   1p6   |   5p3   |   2p1   |
Fng|   2h4   |   1h4   |   1h4   |   1h3   |   2h4   |   2h4   |   4p2   |   4p2   |   3p1   |   4p1   |   4p1   |   4p2   |
Art|    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |
e  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   5h7   |   7p5   |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
B  |---------|---------|---------|---------|   5h7   |---------|---------|   7p5   |---------|---------|---------|---------|
G  |---------|---------|---------|   4h6   |---------|---------|---------|---------|   6p4   |---------|---------|---------|
D  |---------|---------|   4h7   |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   7p4   |---------|---------|
A  |---------|   4h7   |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   7p4   |---------|
E  |   5h7   |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   7p5   |
```

Hammer-on check

Strike close behind the fret with minimal travel. The thumb stays relaxed; volume comes from velocity, not squeezing.

Pull-off check

Pre-fret the lower tone. Use a small lateral pluck and stop before the string is pulled sharp or touches its neighbor.

Root and pulse check

Hear A at E5, D7, e5. Accent roots for one pass, then remove the accents while preserving the 12-attack cycle.

Level 36 - Module A: Position 2 Legato Cell

Second-degree frame. frets 6-10. Roots: D7, B10. One pick attack per two-note group.

String	Frets	Notes	Degrees	Fingers
Low E	7-9	B-C#	2-3	1-3
A	7-9	E-F#	5-6	1-3
D	7-9	A-B	1-2	1-3
G	6-9	C#-E	3-5	1-4
B	7-10	F#-A	6-1	1-4
High e	7-9	B-C#	2-3	1-3

Attack cycle

12 groups / 24 tones / 12 attacks.
D-start: D U D U D U | D U D U D U
U-start: U D U D U D | U D U D U D

Do not re-pick the hammer-on or pull-off arrival. Do not restart at the high-string turn.

Position 2 - 24-tone hammer-on / pull-off cell

Ascending groups use h from low E to high e. Descending groups use p from high e to low E. The high endpoint is re-attacked to begin the descending half.

```
Nte|   BhC#  |   EhF#  |   AhB   |   C#hE  |   F#hA  |   BhC#  |   C#pB  |   ApF#  |   EpC#  |   BpA   |   F#pE  |   C#pB  |
Deg|   2h3   |   5h6   |   1h2   |   3h5   |   6h1   |   2h3   |   3p2   |   1p6   |   5p3   |   2p1   |   6p5   |   3p2   |
Fng|   1h3   |   1h3   |   1h3   |   1h4   |   1h4   |   1h3   |   3p1   |   4p1   |   4p1   |   3p1   |   3p1   |   3p1   |
Art|    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |
e  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   7h9   |   9p7   |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
B  |---------|---------|---------|---------|   7h10  |---------|---------|   10p7  |---------|---------|---------|---------|
G  |---------|---------|---------|   6h9   |---------|---------|---------|---------|   9p6   |---------|---------|---------|
D  |---------|---------|   7h9   |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   9p7   |---------|---------|
A  |---------|   7h9   |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   9p7   |---------|
E  |   7h9   |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   9p7   |
```

Hammer-on check

Strike close behind the fret with minimal travel. The thumb stays relaxed; volume comes from velocity, not squeezing.

Pull-off check

Pre-fret the lower tone. Use a small lateral pluck and stop before the string is pulled sharp or touches its neighbor.

Root and pulse check

Hear A at D7, B10. Accent roots for one pass, then remove the accents while preserving the 12-attack cycle.

Level 36 - Module A: Position 3 Legato Cell

Third-degree frame. frets 9-12. Roots: A12, B10. One pick attack per two-note group.

String	Frets	Notes	Degrees	Fingers
Low E	9-12	C#-E	3-5	1-4
A	9-12	F#-A	6-1	1-4
D	9-11	B-C#	2-3	1-3
G	9-11	E-F#	5-6	1-3
B	10-12	A-B	1-2	2-4
High e	9-12	C#-E	3-5	1-4

Attack cycle

12 groups / 24 tones / 12 attacks.
D-start: D U D U D U | D U D U D U
U-start: U D U D U D | U D U D U D

Do not re-pick the hammer-on or pull-off arrival. Do not restart at the high-string turn.

Position 3 - 24-tone hammer-on / pull-off cell

Ascending groups use h from low E to high e. Descending groups use p from high e to low E. The high endpoint is re-attacked to begin the descending half.

```
Nte|   C#hE  |   F#hA  |   BhC#  |   EhF#  |   AhB   |   C#hE  |   EpC#  |   BpA   |   F#pE  |   C#pB  |   ApF#  |   EpC#  |
Deg|   3h5   |   6h1   |   2h3   |   5h6   |   1h2   |   3h5   |   5p3   |   2p1   |   6p5   |   3p2   |   1p6   |   5p3   |
Fng|   1h4   |   1h4   |   1h3   |   1h3   |   2h4   |   1h4   |   4p1   |   4p2   |   3p1   |   3p1   |   4p1   |   4p1   |
Art|    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |
e  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   9h12  |   12p9  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
B  |---------|---------|---------|---------|  10h12  |---------|---------|  12p10  |---------|---------|---------|---------|
G  |---------|---------|---------|   9h11  |---------|---------|---------|---------|   11p9  |---------|---------|---------|
D  |---------|---------|   9h11  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   11p9  |---------|---------|
A  |---------|   9h12  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   12p9  |---------|
E  |   9h12  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|   12p9  |
```

Hammer-on check

Strike close behind the fret with minimal travel. The thumb stays relaxed; volume comes from velocity, not squeezing.

Pull-off check

Pre-fret the lower tone. Use a small lateral pluck and stop before the string is pulled sharp or touches its neighbor.

Root and pulse check

Hear A at A12, B10. Accent roots for one pass, then remove the accents while preserving the 12-attack cycle.

Level 36 - Module A: Position 4 Legato Cell

Fifth-degree frame. frets 11-14. Roots: A12, G14. One pick attack per two-note group.

String	Frets	Notes	Degrees	Fingers
Low E	12-14	E-F#	5-6	2-4
A	12-14	A-B	1-2	2-4
D	11-14	C#-E	3-5	1-4
G	11-14	F#-A	6-1	1-4
B	12-14	B-C#	2-3	2-4
High e	12-14	E-F#	5-6	2-4

Attack cycle

12 groups / 24 tones / 12 attacks.
D-start: D U D U D U | D U D U D U
U-start: U D U D U D | U D U D U D

Do not re-pick the hammer-on or pull-off arrival. Do not restart at the high-string turn.

Position 4 - 24-tone hammer-on / pull-off cell

Ascending groups use h from low E to high e. Descending groups use p from high e to low E. The high endpoint is re-attacked to begin the descending half.

```
Nte|   EhF#  |   AhB   |   C#hE  |   F#hA  |   BhC#  |   EhF#  |   F#pE  |   C#pB  |   ApF#  |   EpC#  |   BpA   |   F#pE  |
Deg|   5h6   |   1h2   |   3h5   |   6h1   |   2h3   |   5h6   |   6p5   |   3p2   |   1p6   |   5p3   |   2p1   |   6p5   |
Fng|   2h4   |   2h4   |   1h4   |   1h4   |   2h4   |   2h4   |   4p2   |   4p2   |   4p1   |   4p1   |   4p2   |   4p2   |
Art|    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |
e  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|  12h14  |  14p12  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
B  |---------|---------|---------|---------|  12h14  |---------|---------|  14p12  |---------|---------|---------|---------|
G  |---------|---------|---------|  11h14  |---------|---------|---------|---------|  14p11  |---------|---------|---------|
D  |---------|---------|  11h14  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|  14p11  |---------|---------|
A  |---------|  12h14  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|  14p12  |---------|
E  |  12h14  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|  14p12  |
```

Hammer-on check

Strike close behind the fret with minimal travel. The thumb stays relaxed; volume comes from velocity, not squeezing.

Pull-off check

Pre-fret the lower tone. Use a small lateral pluck and stop before the string is pulled sharp or touches its neighbor.

Root and pulse check

Hear A at A12, G14. Accent roots for one pass, then remove the accents while preserving the 12-attack cycle.

Level 36 - Module A: Position 5 Legato Cell

Sixth-degree frame. frets 14-17. Roots: E17, G14, e17. One pick attack per two-note group.

String	Frets	Notes	Degrees	Fingers
Low E	14-17	F#-A	6-1	1-4
A	14-16	B-C#	2-3	1-3
D	14-16	E-F#	5-6	1-3
G	14-16	A-B	1-2	1-3
B	14-17	C#-E	3-5	1-4
High e	14-17	F#-A	6-1	1-4

Attack cycle

12 groups / 24 tones / 12 attacks.
D-start: D U D U D U | D U D U D U
U-start: U D U D U D | U D U D U D

Do not re-pick the hammer-on or pull-off arrival. Do not restart at the high-string turn.

Position 5 - 24-tone hammer-on / pull-off cell

Ascending groups use h from low E to high e. Descending groups use p from high e to low E. The high endpoint is re-attacked to begin the descending half.

```
Nte|   F#hA  |   BhC#  |   EhF#  |   AhB   |   C#hE  |   F#hA  |   ApF#  |   EpC#  |   BpA   |   F#pE  |   C#pB  |   ApF#  |
Deg|   6h1   |   2h3   |   5h6   |   1h2   |   3h5   |   6h1   |   1p6   |   5p3   |   2p1   |   6p5   |   3p2   |   1p6   |
Fng|   1h4   |   1h3   |   1h3   |   1h3   |   1h4   |   1h4   |   4p1   |   4p1   |   3p1   |   3p1   |   3p1   |   4p1   |
Art|    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    h    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |    p    |
e  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|  14h17  |  17p14  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
B  |---------|---------|---------|---------|  14h17  |---------|---------|  17p14  |---------|---------|---------|---------|
G  |---------|---------|---------|  14h16  |---------|---------|---------|---------|  16p14  |---------|---------|---------|
D  |---------|---------|  14h16  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|  16p14  |---------|---------|
A  |---------|  14h16  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|  16p14  |---------|
E  |  14h17  |---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|  17p14  |
```

Hammer-on check

Strike close behind the fret with minimal travel. The thumb stays relaxed; volume comes from velocity, not squeezing.

Pull-off check

Pre-fret the lower tone. Use a small lateral pluck and stop before the string is pulled sharp or touches its neighbor.

Root and pulse check

Hear A at E17, G14, e17. Accent roots for one pass, then remove the accents while preserving the 12-attack cycle.

Level 36 - Module B: One-Pick Seam Chains P1-P3

Five sounding tones from one attack: hammer, slide out, slide back, pull off.

Phrase formula: **lower h anchor / destination \ anchor p lower**. Release the lower finger during the outward slide and replant it during the return; never hold a rigid five-fret stretch.

Seam P1 <-> P2 - 6 strings / 30 tones / 6 attacks

String	One-pick phrase	Degrees	Notes	Hammer/slide finger
Low E	E|5h7/9\7p5|	1-2-3-2-1	A-B-C#-B-A	3
A	A|4h7/9\7p4|	3-5-6-5-3	C#-E-F#-E-C#	4
D	D|4h7/9\7p4|	6-1-2-1-6	F#-A-B-A-F#	4
G	G|4h6/9\6p4|	2-3-5-3-2	B-C#-E-C#-B	3
B	B|5h7/10\7p5|	5-6-1-6-5	E-F#-A-F#-E	3
High e	e|5h7/9\7p5|	1-2-3-2-1	A-B-C#-B-A	3

Seam P2 <-> P3 - 6 strings / 30 tones / 6 attacks

String	One-pick phrase	Degrees	Notes	Hammer/slide finger
Low E	E|7h9/12\9p7|	2-3-5-3-2	B-C#-E-C#-B	3
A	A|7h9/12\9p7|	5-6-1-6-5	E-F#-A-F#-E	3
D	D|7h9/11\9p7|	1-2-3-2-1	A-B-C#-B-A	3
G	G|6h9/11\9p6|	3-5-6-5-3	C#-E-F#-E-C#	4
B	B|7h10/12\10p7|	6-1-2-1-6	F#-A-B-A-F#	4
High e	e|7h9/12\9p7|	2-3-5-3-2	B-C#-E-C#-B	3

Practice pass 1: one sounding tone per click. Pass 2: one five-note quintuplet per beat. Pass 3: reverse the string order. No extra pick at either slide arrival.

Level 36 - Module B: One-Pick Seam Chains P3-P5

Five sounding tones from one attack: hammer, slide out, slide back, pull off.

Phrase formula: **lower h anchor / destination \ anchor p lower**. Release the lower finger during the outward slide and replant it during the return; never hold a rigid five-fret stretch.

Seam P3 <-> P4 - 6 strings / 30 tones / 6 attacks

String	One-pick phrase	Degrees	Notes	Hammer/slide finger
Low E	E|9h12/14\12p9|	3-5-6-5-3	C#-E-F#-E-C#	4
A	A|9h12/14\12p9|	6-1-2-1-6	F#-A-B-A-F#	4
D	D|9h11/14\11p9|	2-3-5-3-2	B-C#-E-C#-B	3
G	G|9h11/14\11p9|	5-6-1-6-5	E-F#-A-F#-E	3
B	B|10h12/14\12p10|	1-2-3-2-1	A-B-C#-B-A	3
High e	e|9h12/14\12p9|	3-5-6-5-3	C#-E-F#-E-C#	4

Seam P4 <-> P5 - 6 strings / 30 tones / 6 attacks

String	One-pick phrase	Degrees	Notes	Hammer/slide finger
Low E	E|12h14/17\14p12|	5-6-1-6-5	E-F#-A-F#-E	3
A	A|12h14/16\14p12|	1-2-3-2-1	A-B-C#-B-A	3
D	D|11h14/16\14p11|	3-5-6-5-3	C#-E-F#-E-C#	4
G	G|11h14/16\14p11|	6-1-2-1-6	F#-A-B-A-F#	4
B	B|12h14/17\14p12|	2-3-5-3-2	B-C#-E-C#-B	3
High e	e|12h14/17\14p12|	5-6-1-6-5	E-F#-A-F#-E	3

Practice pass 1: one sounding tone per click. Pass 2: one five-note quintuplet per beat. Pass 3: reverse the string order. No extra pick at either slide arrival.

Level 36 - Module C: Whole-Step Bend Intonation

Nine named bend sites on G, B, and high e. The target fret is the pitch authority.

Four-attack bend cell

```
G|--6----4b(6)----4b(6)r4----6~~~~~~|
    1       2          3         4     attacks
    C#      B->C#      B->C#->B  C# + vibrato
    deg 3   2->3       2->3->2   deg 3
```

Attack 1 establishes the target. Attack 2 bends and holds. Attack 3 bends and releases. Attack 4 confirms the fretted target and adds narrow vibrato.

Intonation sequence

1. Play target and memorize it.
2. Bend slowly until the beats disappear.
3. Hold the target for one full beat.
4. Release without dropping early.
5. Only then add vibrato.

String	Source fret	Target fret	Source	Target	Degree path
G	4	6	B	C#	2->3
G	9	11	E	F#	5->6
G	14	16	A	B	1->2
B	5	7	E	F#	5->6
B	10	12	A	B	1->2
B	12	14	B	C#	2->3
High e	5	7	A	B	1->2
High e	7	9	B	C#	2->3
High e	12	14	E	F#	5->6

Muting audit

Fretting index lightly touches the string above the bend. Picking hand silences lower strings. No sympathetic ringing.

Pitch audit

The bend is not "close enough." Alternate target fret and bent target until no pitch difference remains.

Safety boundary

All printed bends are whole steps. Do not force the three-semitone pentatonic gaps. Stop for pain or persistent tension.

Level 36 - Module C: Nine Bend Cells

Complete separate G-string, B-string, and high-e passes before linking them.

G STRING - each cell uses 4 attacks

```
G|--6----4b(6)----4b(6)r4----6~~~~--|
```
B(2) -> C#(3)

```
G|--11----9b(11)----9b(11)r9----11~~~~--|
```
E(5) -> F#(6)

```
G|--16----14b(16)----14b(16)r14----16~~~~--|
```
A(1) -> B(2)

Passes: 1) target + bend only; 2) full bend-release cell; 3) D-start and U-start; 4) record and compare.

B STRING - each cell uses 4 attacks

```
B|--7----5b(7)----5b(7)r5----7~~~~--|
```
E(5) -> F#(6)

```
B|--12----10b(12)----10b(12)r10----12~~~~--|
```
A(1) -> B(2)

```
B|--14----12b(14)----12b(14)r12----14~~~~--|
```
B(2) -> C#(3)

Passes: 1) target + bend only; 2) full bend-release cell; 3) D-start and U-start; 4) record and compare.

HIGH E STRING - each cell uses 4 attacks

```
e|--7----5b(7)----5b(7)r5----7~~~~--|
```
A(1) -> B(2)

```
e|--9----7b(9)----7b(9)r7----9~~~~--|
```
B(2) -> C#(3)

```
e|--14----12b(14)----12b(14)r12----14~~~~--|
```
E(5) -> F#(6)

Passes: 1) target + bend only; 2) full bend-release cell; 3) D-start and U-start; 4) record and compare.

Level 36 - Module D: Pre-Bend Releases and Vibrato

The pre-bend begins at the target pitch; vibrato begins only after the target is stable.

Six pre-bend release cells

Cell: fretted target -> silent pre-bend and release -> fresh bend to target with vibrato. Three attacks per site.

```
G|--11----9pb(11)r9----9b(11)~~~~~-|        E(5) -> F#(6)

G|--16----14pb(16)r14----14b(16)~~~~~-|      A(1) -> B(2)

B|--7----5pb(7)r5----5b(7)~~~~~-|            E(5) -> F#(6)

B|--12----10pb(12)r10----10b(12)~~~~~-|      A(1) -> B(2)

e|--9----7pb(9)r7----7b(9)~~~~~-|            B(2) -> C#(3)

e|--14----12pb(14)r12----12b(14)~~~~~-|      E(5) -> F#(6)
```

No scoop is allowed before the pre-bent attack. Set the pitch silently, then pick.

Eight A-root vibrato holds

String	Fret(s)
Low E	5, 17
A	12
D	7
G	14
B	10
High e	5, 17

Pass 1: four narrow pulses over four beats.
Pass 2: six pulses over four beats.
Pass 3: free vibrato, always returning to A.

Bent-note vibrato: reach the target first; use tiny release-and-return pulses centered on it.

Fretted-note vibrato

Use a relaxed wrist rotation. The original fret pitch is the lower boundary and the return point of every pulse. Keep the thumb and forearm free of excess tension.

Bent-note vibrato

Hold the whole-step target without sagging. Add very small release-and-return pulses. Recheck against the fretted target after every three repetitions.

Tone and gain rule

Use a clean tone first. Gain can hide weak hammer-ons and exaggerate string noise. Add gain only after the pitch center, muting, and attack counts are secure.

Level 36 - Module E: Five Expressive Cadences

One short phrase per position. Every phrase resolves to A and combines the earlier articulation modules.

Position 1 cadence - bend, release, and root vibrato

frets 4-7 | 4 pick attacks

```
e|--5h7p5--------------------------|
B|----------7p5--------------------|
G|--------------4b(6)r4------------|
D|----------------------7~~~~------|
A|---------------------------------|
E|---------------------------------|
```

Degrees: 1-2-1 | 6-5 | 2-bend-to-3-release-2 | 1

Position 2 cadence - legato, seam slide, bend, and root

frets 6-10 | 4 pick attacks

```
e|----------------7b(9)r7----------|
B|--------7/10------------10~~~~--|
G|--6h9p6-------------------------|
D|---------------------------------|
A|---------------------------------|
E|---------------------------------|
```

Degrees: 3-5-3 | 6-slide-to-1 | 2-bend-to-3-release-2 | 1

Position 3 cadence - paired legato, bend, and tonic return

frets 9-12 | 4 pick attacks

```
e|--9h12p9-------------------------|
B|----------10h12p10--------10~~~~|
G|--------------------9b(11)r9-----|
D|---------------------------------|
A|---------------------------------|
E|---------------------------------|
```

Degrees: 3-5-3 | 1-2-1 | 5-bend-to-6-release-5 | 1

Position 4 cadence - top-string legato, bend, and slide to root

frets 11-14 | 3 pick attacks

```
e|--12h14p12-----------------------|
B|------------12b(14)r12-----------|
G|----------------------11/14~~~~~-|
D|---------------------------------|
A|---------------------------------|
E|---------------------------------|
```

Degrees: 5-6-5 | 2-bend-to-3-release-2 | 6-slide-to-1

Position 5 cadence - octave frame and final A resolution

frets 14-17 | 4 pick attacks

Degrees: 6-1-6 | 5-3 | 1-bend-to-2-release-1 | 1
Notes: F#-A-F# | E-C# | A-B-A | A

```
e|--14h17p14----------------17~~~~|
B|------------17p14----------------|
G|------------------14b(16)r14-----|
D|---------------------------------|
A|---------------------------------|
E|---------------------------------|
```

Link P1-P5 with one bar of rest, then remove the rests. Continue alternate picking through the actual attacks; do not add an attack to any legato, slide, bend, release, or vibrato arrival.

Level 36 - Practice Progression, Mastery Gate, and Log

Pitch and muting outrank speed. Advance only after clean performance on separate days.

Eight-phase practice progression

1. Map the notation; say each note and degree.
2. Learn Position 1 at one sounding tone per click.
3. Complete all five legato cells with both pick starts.
4. Add the 24 one-pick seam chains.
5. Calibrate one bend, then all nine bend sites.
6. Add six pre-bend cells and eight root holds.
7. Play the five cadences separately.
8. Link the cadences without extra attacks.

Counts, repair rules, and advancement

Module	Workload	Pick attacks
A - legato cells	120 tones	60
B - seam chains	120 tones	24
C - bends	9 cells	36
D - pre-bend + roots	6 cells + 8 holds	26
E - cadences	5 phrases	19
Core total	mixed articulation	165

WEAK LEGATO: reduce travel; keep the target pre-fretted.
LATE SLIDE: count the arrival as a note.
FLAT/SHARP BEND: compare with target; hold before vibrato.
NOISE: audit both fretting- and picking-hand muting.
PAIN/TENSION: stop; do not force the bend.
ADVANCE: add 2 BPM after three clean runs; after two errors reduce 4-6 BPM or shorten the module.

Mastery gate before Level 37

Play all five legato cells with equal picked and unpicked volume; execute all 24 seam chains from one attack; match all nine whole-step bends to their target frets; perform six pre-bend releases without a scoop; hold all eight A roots with controlled vibrato; link the five cadences on two separate days; and identify every bend source, target, and final root by note and degree.

Practice log

Date	Focus	D/U	BPM	Pitch clean?	Weak articulation / site	Next target

NEXT Level 37 applies A major pentatonic to I-IV-V harmony, targeting chord tones over A, D, and E major.